

Gold Annotation Guidelines

Introduction

These annotation guidelines were informed by prior work on computational argumentation and argument mining by Ruiz-Dolz et al. (2025) and refined for the present study, which investigates argumentative structures in AI-generated personalised health narratives for older adults. The objective is to identify Argumentative Discourse Units (ADUs) and assign one of three labels: CLAIM, PREMISE, or NONE. The resulting annotations serve as the human-consensus gold standard for evaluating the LLM-based argument-mining component used in the present study.

1. Unit of Annotation

Annotation is performed at the level of Argumentative Discourse Units (ADUs). Each ADU receives exactly one label. Where a sentence contained more than one argumentative function, it was segmented into separate ADUs where a meaningful separation could be made. Where segmentation would make the resulting units semantically incomplete, the unit was retained and assigned the label corresponding to its predominant argumentative function.

Example:

CLAIM: Go for a short walk on two days.

PREMISE: Movement clears your head and helps sleep.

2. Annotation Principles

- Annotate argumentative function rather than grammatical structure.
- Assign only one label to each ADU.
- Split sentences containing multiple argumentative functions.
- Recommendations expressed politely (e.g., 'You could...', 'Consider...') are still CLAIMS.

3. CLAIM

A recommendation, suggestion, encouragement, conclusion, or proposed course of action.

Examples:

- Continue your morning walks.
- Consider attending the art group.
- Make time for regular stretching.

4. PREMISE

A reason, explanation, evidence, or justification supporting a CLAIM.

Examples:

- Walking improves sleep.
- Social interaction reduces loneliness.
- Stretching improves flexibility.

5. NONE

Narrative descriptions, greetings, summaries of activities, observations, reflections, or contextual information that neither recommends nor justifies an action.

Examples:

- You enjoy reading novels.
- Gardening has become part of your routine.
- You spoke with your sister yesterday.

6. Decision Rules

1. Recommendations → CLAIM
2. Supporting reasons → PREMISE
3. Descriptive statements → NONE
4. Split recommendation + justification into separate ADUs.
5. Label according to argumentative function, not sentence structure.

7. Ambiguous Cases

You enjoy reading novels. → NONE

Continue reading every evening. → CLAIM

Reading helps you relax before bedtime. → PREMISE

8. Consensus Procedure

An initial annotation pass assigned CLAIM, PREMISE, or NONE labels to the segmented ADUs. The annotations were subsequently reviewed by a second researcher. Cases of disagreement or uncertainty were referred for additional co-author review, and the final gold-standard labels reflect the resulting consensus.

9. Scope

These annotations identify argument components only. They do not assess whether narrative content is supported by the persona/activity information. Persona grounding and argumentation-scheme effects are evaluated separately.

References

Ruiz-Dolz, R., Heras, S., & García-Fornes, A. (2025). An introduction to computational argumentation research from a human argumentation perspective. *Autonomous Agents and Multi-Agent Systems*, 39(11). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10458-025-09692-x>